



Beneath a Crimson Banner

A Total War: Three Kingdoms Modlist for v1.7.2

Three Waves · Three Campaigns · One Destiny

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Wave 0 — The Warlord’s First Steps

Roleplaying Background

The Han dynasty crumbles. Yellow Turban rebels burn the countryside, and warlords across the land sharpen their blades. You are not yet among them — you are a minor official, a displaced captain, or a wandering scholar. The world is vast and dangerous. Every decision matters.

Your goal: survive. Learn the land. Build a following.

Game Setup

| Setting | Choice | |---|---| | Difficulty | Normal | | Campaign | Mandate of Heaven / Rise of the Warlords (any) | | Faction | Any recommended starter faction (e.g., Cao Cao, Sun Jian, Liu Bei) | | Turn Timer | Unlimited | | Battle Time Limit | 60 min |

Mods in This Wave

This wave uses only UI improvements and quality-of-life mods. No gameplay overhauls. This is the vanilla experience — polished.

How to Use This Guide

Read 02-how-to-play.md for a complete beginner’s guide to the game’s systems. The mod list above is installed via TW Mod Manager — see setup-installation-guide.md for instructions.

Mod List

Example UI Improvement Mod

by ExampleAuthor

v1.0.0

UI

Improves the campaign map UI with better tooltips and information panels.

Load after any total conversion mods.

Example QoL Fixes

by AnotherAuthor

v2.3.1

QOL

Fixes various quality-of-life issues including diplomatic feedback and recruitment sorting.

⚠️ Conflict:

Example UI Improvement Mod → Load after Example UI Improvement Mod

Wave 1 — The Kingdom Endures

Roleplaying Background

Years have passed. Your warlord now commands a stable domain — a true kingdom with borders, allies, and enemies. The world is no longer about survival but about expansion. Trade routes stretch across your lands. Your generals are seasoned veterans. But new threats gather at every border.

Your goal: secure your kingdom’s future through diplomacy, strategy, and well-placed force.

Game Setup

| Setting | Choice | |---|---| | Difficulty | Hard | | Campaign | Rise of the Warlords | | Faction | Any major regional power (e.g., Gongsun Zan, Yuan Shao, Liu Biao) | | Turn Timer | Unlimited | | Battle Time Limit | 60 min |

What’s New

- **Graphics overhaul** — the world looks richer and more immersive
- **Content mods** — new units, buildings, and events
- **Audio pack** — thematic battle music
- **Mechanic mods** — deeper systems (may affect diplomacy, economy, or spies)

Strategy Shift

On Hard difficulty, the AI is more aggressive and makes smarter decisions. Read 02-strategy.md for advanced tactics.

Mod List

Example Graphics Overhaul by GraphicsAuthor v2.0.0 GRAPHICS High-resolution textures for units, buildings, and campaign map. Requires high-end GPU.
Example Content Expansion by ContentAuthor v1.5.0 CONTENT Adds new unique units, buildings, and events for several factions. Dependencies: Example Graphics Overhaul ⚠ Conflict: Another Content Mod → Load this one first, then Another Content Mod ⚙ Adds unique faction buildings with new recruitment options Start a new campaign after enabling.
Example Audio Pack by AudioAuthor v1.0.0

AUDIO

Replaces battle music with traditional Chinese instruments.

Compatible with all overhauls.

Wave 2 — Beneath a Crimson Banner

Roleplaying Background

The empire burns. You are no longer a warlord or a king — you are the last hope of a dying age. Your territories stretch across China, but every border is contested. Generals scheme for your throne. The people grow restless. Three kingdoms stand between you and ultimate dominion, and the world itself seems to conspire against you.

This is the final wave. There is no backup plan. No retreat. Only victory or annihilation.

Your goal: unite China under your banner — or watch it all burn.

Game Setup

| Setting | Choice | |---| |---| | Difficulty | Legendary | | Campaign | Mandate of Heaven | | Faction | Any (recommend a faction you know well from Waves 0-1) | | Turn Timer | Unlimited | | Battle Time Limit | 60 min |

What's New

- **Full mechanical overhauls** — diplomacy, economy, and characters work differently
- **Endgame crisis events** — scripted challenges that test your empire
- **Maximum difficulty** — Legendary AI morale bonuses, no battle saves
- **Compatibility considerations** — some Wave 1 mods conflict; read carefully

The Challenge

Wave 2 is designed for players who have mastered Waves 0-1. If you haven't completed at least one campaign on Hard with Wave 1's modset, consider playing more before starting this wave.

Mod List

Example Total Overhaul by OverhaulAuthor

v3.0.0

MECHANICS

Complete overhaul of diplomacy, economy, and character systems.

Dependencies: Example Graphics Overhaul

⚠ **Conflict:** Example Content Expansion → Compatible only with patches from the mod page. Use the compatibility patch.

⚠ **Conflict:** Vanilla Diplomacy Fix → Incompatible — do not use together

⚙ Replaces the entire diplomacy system with a deeper offer-and-demand negotiation model. Adds population mechanics to economy. Introduces general loyalty factions.

Requires new campaign. Read the mod page carefully.

Example Endgame Challenge by ChallengeAuthor

v1.2.0

MECHANICS

Adds late-game crisis events, horde armies, and empire-shattering dilemmas.

Dependencies: Example Total Overhaul

⚙️ Adds scripted endgame scenarios that trigger when certain conditions are met (e.g., territory count, prestige level)

Can be toggled on/off mid-campaign.

Appendices

Mod Installation Guide

Setup & Installation Guide

Total War Mod Manager (TWMM)

TW Mod Manager is the recommended tool for managing Total War: Three Kingdoms mods.

Download & Install

1. Visit <https://www.nexusmods.com/site/mods/1238>
2. Download the latest version
3. Run the installer
4. On first launch, point TWMM to your Total War: Three Kingdoms installation folder (typically `steamapps/common/Total War THREE KINGDOMS`)

Importing a Modlist

Each wave directory contains a `mods.yaml` file listing all mods and their sources.

1. Download each mod from its Nexus/Steam Workshop URL
2. Place `.pack` files in `Total War THREE KINGDOMS/data/`
3. Open TWMM — it scans the data folder and lists all detected mods
4. Check the mods you want to enable for your current wave
5. Arrange load order (see below)

Load Order Rules

1. **Dependencies before dependents** — if Mod B needs Mod A, Mod A loads first
2. **UI mods load last** — UI changes should override everything else
3. **Audio mods load before content mods** — prevents conflicts
4. **Total overhauls load first** — they change the foundation everything else builds on

TWMM allows drag-and-drop reordering. Use the “Groups” feature to save load order profiles for each wave.

Verifying Compatibility

- TWMM checks for known conflicts and shows warnings
- Cross-reference with `conflicts.yaml` for tracked issues
- If TWMM shows a conflict, check the resolution field in the mod entry or `conflicts.yaml`

Per-Wave Profiles

1. In TWMM, create a “Wave 0” group with those mods enabled and all others disabled
2. When moving to Wave 1, disable all Wave 0 mods first, then enable Wave 1 mods
3. This prevents cross-wave conflicts

Manual Installation (Without TWMM)

1. Download mod `.pack` files
2. Place in `steamapps/common/Total War THREE KINGDOMS/data/`
3. Launch the game launcher
4. Go to “Mod Manager” tab
5. Enable mods in the correct order
6. Launch the game

“Note: The game’s built-in mod manager is less capable than TWMM. TWMM is strongly recommended.”